

Achint Sharma

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Education

Ph.D. candidate in Cognitive and Information Sciences (Started in August 2023- Present)

University of California, Merced

Currently part of the Bortfeld lab and the Cognitive Auditory Neuroscience (CAN) lab. Actively involved in research on audiovisual integration in speech.

MS in Cognitive Science

Center of Behavioral and Cognitive Sciences, University of Allahabad, Allahabad, India

Master's thesis on understanding atypical EEG oscillatory neuro-dynamics in response to social cues like gaze in autism spectrum disorder. In the study, I worked with children from the age range of 6 to 13 years. It gave me experience designing child-friendly experiments using response tools like a joystick. I performed EEG time-frequency data analysis using EEGLAB.

Research/Work Experience

Research Assistant

March 2022 – May 2023

Multisensory Processing Lab, University of California, Los Angeles

- I conducted the data collection for the project and supervised the collection of experimental data for over 150 participants. Data sorting and behavioral statistical analysis were performed using Python. The paper on the research findings is in the process of publication.
- Contributed to the design phase of a project on multisensory integration and learning.
- Publication: Shams LT, Föry A, Sharma A, Shams L (2023) Big number, big body: Jersey numbers alter body size perception. PLoS ONE 18(9): e0287474.

Case Manager

Jan 2020 - Jun 2021

Heartland Human Care Services, Chicago

- Worked with children, families, clinical psychologists, teachers, social workers, and attorneys to prepare the cases of unaccompanied immigrant minors. Managed cases to meet participant's legal, safety, and mental health needs.
- Additional responsibilities: management of data records.

Jr. Research fellow

Feb 2019 - Dec 2019

Cognitive and Behavioral Neuroscience (CBN) Lab, Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay

- Project manager for - Cognitive Marker of ADHD subtype: Development of a diagnostic tool.
- Managed a large experimental data pool and analyzed it using multinomial logistic regression and receiver operating curve.
- Analyzed and scored assessment scales like Conners' Parent Rating Scale for ADHD and Gilliam Autism Rating Scale (GARS).
- Mentored fellow researchers on data collection techniques to bring uniformity to the process.

Volunteer experience

- Worked with NGO 'Abhyasika' in organizing after-school classes for children from economically disadvantaged backgrounds.

- Volunteered for an outreach initiative for the screening of dementia organized at the Center of Behavior and Cognitive Sciences. Geriatric subjects were examined for age-related Mild Cognitive Impairments (MCI) using dementia tests to evaluate their cognitive function.

Conference, Workshops, Scholarship & Award

- Presented poster of my study “**Effect of Context-dependent Visual Information on the Audio-Visual Time Flow Illusion**” at the **Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference in April 2025**.
- Received **MacKenzie Scott Graduate Student Supplemental Travel Award** in January 2025.
- Participated in an EEGLAB workshop on advanced methods of EEG data analysis at the University of California, San Diego, in Nov 2022.
- Sharma A, Kar B. R., Srivastava C. (2018). **Resting state and task-based EEG related to gaze in Autism Spectrum Disorder** Proceedings of the 5th Annual Conference of Cognitive Science (ACCS), IIT Guwahati, India.
- Participated in a workshop titled “**An Introduction to Sensory Processing Disorders and Sensory Integration Therapy**”, **organized to educate about the** sensory experiences of autistic children and relative behavioral therapies. JUNE 17th and 18th 2017
- Received a merit scholarship from the Center of Behavior and Cognitive Sciences (CBCS) in 2017.